A Monk Who Means Business

4 YOGI ADITYANATH, 50

CHIEF MINISTER, UTTAR PRADESH

BECAUSE Yogi has come into his own as a distinctive political brand with a real catchment area—the second most popular mass leader in the BJP after PM Modi. After a scorching win in his re-election bid, 'Bulldozer Baba' went into a silent zone of hard-core policy action, emerging only with his steely drive to take out mafiosi, his esteem going up a few notches in the process

BECAUSE he is the most in-demand leader in the BJP's election campaigns after the PM, with a pan-India following

KEEP IT SIMPLE **'Maharajji', as his devouts call him, lives simple. A vegetarian and a pet-lover, Yogi is fond of reading Hindi fiction, Kashinath Singh being a favourite**

BECAUSE he recently broke a 63-year-old record for longest unbroken stint as UP CM, surpassing Dr Sampoornanand's 5 yrs, 345 days



Illustration by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**



5 RAHUL GANDHI, 52

CONGRESS LEADER

Illustration by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

WALKING THE TALK

BECAUSE it was from the abyssal depths of failure itself that he rose again—clothing his grit with a winning smile as he took one step and then the next, over all of 4,080 kilometres, across the length of India. Rahul's Bharat Jodo Yatra not only put life back into a dispirited Congress—which has re-established its centrality in the fluid Opposition space—he was himself reborn as a serious politician. It paid electoral dividends too: the Congress got its mojo back as it wrested Karnataka, winning 37 of the 51 seats in the seven districts the BJY covered

BECAUSE he is now the most vocal and influential Opposition leader in the country, never shying from taking on the prime minister. The fact that his every statement and move is attacked by Modi's cabinet colleagues and the BJP IT cell is proof of his hard-won imprint on Indian politics

SENT MAIL **Though he has a team to look after his social media accounts, he often posts himself, in tweets laced with wit and sarcasm**

BECAUSE even though he has been disqualified as a parliamentarian now, Rahul is the face of the Grand Old Party. Nearly 200 Lok Sabha seats will see a direct Congress-BJP contest, making his role as the keeper of the flame, and the esprit de corps, even more significant